

APPENDIX B — CREATING YOUR OWN CONTENT

Homebrewing is the process of creating your own unique material for use in a campaign or made to challenge yourself, help others, etc.

CREATING YOUR OWN TECHNIQUES

Many accomplished ninja have created their own techniques during their adventures. While this is certainly not necessary to become a powerful and recognised individual, many shinobi will find it useful, as you can create techniques that are more specific to your own style of combat, and such techniques may help fill empty spaces in your repertoire.

Note: All of the processes and notes in this appendix are merely a rough indicator of power levels. They are not to be used as ‘proof’ that a self-made technique is balanced, merely to be used as guidelines.

LEARN AND PERFORM REQUIREMENTS

All techniques require a number of statistics before they can be used. Some of these can be calculated very easily, such as the following:

Learn DC: $10 + \text{Technique Rank} + \text{Modifiers}$

Successes: $\text{Complexity Class} + \text{Modifiers}$.

Skill Threshold: $\text{Technique Rank} + \text{Modifiers}$.

Perform DC: $10 + \text{Technique Rank} + \text{Modifiers}$.

Table B-1: Technique Statistics shows the possible modifiers and values.

TABLE B-1: TECHNIQUE STATISTICS

Complexity	Learn DC	Successes	Skill Threshold	Perform DC
Extremely Easy	+1	1	+0	-10
Very Easy	+1	1	+0	-5
Easy	+1	1	+0	-1
E-Class	+1	1	+0	+0
D-Class	+2	1	+0	+1
C-Class	+3	2	+1	+3
B-Class	+4	3	+2	+5
A-Class	+5	4	+3	+7
S-Class	+6	5	+4	+10
SS-Class	+7	6	+5	+15
Epic	+15	8	+8	+20
Special				
Hijutsu	-	+1	-	-
Kinjutsu	-	+2	-	-
Combination	+5	-2	-	-

A Combination technique is defined as a technique that essentially combines two existing techniques, usually for a greater overall effect.

DEFINING RANK AND COMPLEXITY

Defining a technique’s Rank can be a challenge, and there is no easy formula to properly categorize every possible technique effect. However, for techniques with common effects, an easy method is to look at existing techniques and see which techniques deal similar damage with a similar range and/or area of effect, and move from there.

For most non-damaging techniques, the comparison has to come from techniques that have similar effects, such as applying conditions or penalties.

Complexity is mostly based on lore considerations: was the technique designed for academy students, or is it mostly wielded by Jounin-level characters? Rank and Complexity offers some basic explanation of the different Complexities. However, Complexity does affect a technique’s Learn DC, Successes and Perform Requirements, so balance considerations are not unimportant: Complexity is a useful guideline towards establishing a techniques Range, Area of Effect and maximum possible effect (with higher complexities reaching greater areas and higher possible limits). If in doubt, balance should always be the most important.

TIME

Most techniques require an Attack action to perform.

Techniques with exceptionally powerful or long-lasting effects, as well as most utility effects with greater impact (like creating structures) would require a full round. Stances always take a Swift action.

Complex or high-level sealing techniques that use rituals often require longer to perform, as do medical techniques for complex methods of treatments. Such times can range from minutes to hours, in very rare cases even a day or more.

COMPONENTS

In the majority of cases, non-Taijutsu techniques will require hand seals and concentration, while Taijutsu techniques often require mobility or being physically able, as well as a material focus if it's a weapon attack.

Techniques will require a material focus or expendable components if their effects should logically require them (an effect creating a whirlpool should require a significant amount of water, raising a slab of rock should require hard earth or rock, etc).

VITAL STATISTICS

A technique's 'vital statistics' are its Range, Target(s), Area, Damage (if any) and Cost, which are linked.

The average damage to Chakra ratio (as in, how much average damage is dealt per point of Chakra spent) of a technique should range from 2 to 3, based on its Rank and Complexity (a higher Rank, and especially a higher complexity, should allow for a higher ratio).

The average assumes a single target is hit and does not successfully save. Attacks enhancing your melee attacks assume one to two successful hits per round (higher Ranks will lean towards 2). Techniques requiring multiple attacks assume half the attacks hit (rounded up). Touch attacks are assumed to always hit. If the technique causes a creature to catch on fire, add 1 average damage times the maximum duration of the burn (1d4 rounds comes to an average 4 damage).

Range	Cost	Area	
Touch or Close	+0	Cone	+1
Medium or Long	+1	Line (5 ft. wide)	+1
Targets	Cost	Line (10+ ft. wide)	+2
One Creature	0	10-15 ft. Square	+1
2-5 targets	+1	5-10ft Burst *	+1
6+	+2	15-20 ft Burst	+2
		Larger	+3

Once you've calculated the rough Cost the technique should have, add increases based on its other statistics, as shown in the table above. If your area is unique, try to figure out what type of area would be similar in size (if the shape allows for an easier way to target multiple spread out creatures without harming allies, you may wish to add an extra +1 if the technique is not a high Rank and/or complexity).

It should be noted that techniques of Rank 1 and 2 usually do not have Medium or Long range, and that techniques below Rank 6 are usually limited to Medium range at best. Similarly, techniques Rank 2 or lower usually don't have an area of effect, and techniques Rank 8 or lower usually don't have an area that would grant it a +2 bonus to the cost.

TAIJUTSU TECHNIQUES

Generally speaking, Taijutsu techniques cost slightly less, as such techniques have short range, rely on attack rolls and deal types of damage that are most likely to be resisted.

EMPOWERMENT

In most cases, a technique offering empowerment either adds 1d6 damage per point of Chakra. If the technique deals damage in higher die sizes, the cost should be higher (such as 2 per 1d10, or 3 per 2d8).

If the technique's empowerment merely allows firing multiple projectiles (or affecting multiple targets/areas with the same effect), the cost of empowering should equal the base cost of the technique (1 more or less is allowed based on the complexity and Rank).

NON-DAMAGING EFFECTS

A technique that adds a minor effect (such as a knockback, a slight penalty to certain rolls, small temporary ability score penalty, deafness, and effects of a similar impact) usually adds +1 to its Cost, or +2 if it affects an area.

If the effect is major (stun, paralysis), the cost increases by 2, or 3 for techniques with a small area of effect. Such effects should generally not be added to techniques with larger areas of effect. The duration of such effects should also be minor (1 round for areas of effect, up to 2 or 3 average rounds for techniques with a single target).

Chakra Coils damage is very rare, and should be used very sparingly. Usually, such techniques deal subpar damage for their cost and rank, and always directly target individual creatures (never areas of effect).

The duration of the effect should scale based on Rank and complexity: A rank 3 technique should not be capable of stunning creatures for 2 or 3 rounds.

TECHNIQUES DEALING NO DAMAGE

Techniques whose primary use is utility have no set rules: it is best to compare their level of usefulness to existing utility techniques.

Techniques that primarily afflict targets with conditions or penalties should try to compare them to existing techniques, as the possibilities vary greatly and such effects are often difficult to quantify.

ENHANCEMENT SEALS AND SEALED ITEMS

More than anything, enhancement seals and sealed items rely on comparative strength: there is no tried and true method for assigning a power level other than trying to compare them to existing enhancement seals or sealed items. However, a few metrics do have steady rules that you can follow:

SEAL LEVEL AND RANK

A seal's level and rank are linked: If you know what Rank a seal has, you can determine the range of levels it is meant for. Similarly, if you know its intended level, you will know its Rank. Table B-2: Special Tool Costs shows these relations.

If the item carries an enhancement bonus, it should not exceed +1 per rank (i.e. Greater is no more than +3). If the additional effects on the seal are minor, you can simply raise its level within the rank boundaries. If the effects are substantial, you may need to increase the seal's level and Rank more.

MATERIAL COST

The purchase DC of the materials required to craft an enhancement seal or sealed item is calculated according to the table below. The entry for charges refers to when items have a limited number of uses, which affects the cost to construct them (and, subsequently, purchase them). Rules concerning the market price of sealed items are found in Chapter 13.

TABLE B-2: SPECIAL TOOL COSTS

Seal	Level	Material Cost
Rank		
Minor	1-6	10 + seal level
Superior	7-12	15 + seal level
Greater	13-20	20 + seal level
Epic	21-27	10 + 1.5x seal level
Legendary	28-35	10 + 1.5x seal level
Type		
Armor Seal		-
Weapon Seal		
Sealed Item		+1 per rank
Charges	Cost Modifier	
5	-1	
4	-2	
3	-3	
2	-4	
1	-5	